LORENZO UTTINI

London, United Kingdom
(+39)3337505793 ⋄ uttini.lorenzo@gmail.com ⋄ LinkedIn ⋄ GitHub ⋄ Website ⋄ Google Scholar

WORK EXPERIENCE

Imperial College, London (UK) *August 2026 - Present*
PhD candidate - Supervised by Prof. Edward Johns

- Researching post-training methods for autonomous dexterous manipulation with five-finger robotic hands, leveraging reinforcement learning to improve vision-language-action foundation models.
- Leading Imperial's team on GRAIL, an EU Horizon-funded, four-year initiative to develop Europe's first general-purpose foundation model for robotics.

Armnet, London (UK) *April 2026 - August 2026*
Research ML Engineer

- First hire; helped build the first remote robotic manipulation farm. Designed dexterous manipulation tasks and post-trained VLA architectures using state-of-the-art RL techniques to improve benchmark performance.
- Architected a cloud-native actor-learner RL pipeline that post-trains VLA policies online across the robot fleet, offloading GPU training to the cloud while actors run on-cell.

Humanoid, London (UK) *June 2025 - March 2026*
Control Engineer Intern

- First intern; contributed to manipulation capability development for the company's humanoid robotic hands by implementing control algorithms for teleoperation and autonomous grasping.
- Developed a kinematic retargeting pipeline enabling real-time teleoperation of 12-DOF Robotera hands across glove, VR and vision-based systems for responsive human-robot interaction.

Cy4gate, Rome (Italy) *February 2024 - May 2024*
Machine Learning Engineer Intern

- Developed ML models to detect malicious DGA-generated domains, processing 200k+ domains and deploying the best model via an interactive Streamlit app.

EDUCATION

University College London, UK *September 2024 - September 2025*
MSc in Robotics and Artificial Intelligence **Graduated: Distinction**
Relevant Courses: Reinforcement Learning, Legged Robotics, Robotics Manipulation
Graduate Research Student - Supervised by Prof. Valerio Modugno

San Francisco State University, USA *August 2023 - December 2023*
Exchange Semester **GPA: 4.0/4.0**
Relevant Courses: Machine Learning for Healthcare, AI Explanability
Top 3% of the batch over 100+ students

University of Pavia, Italy *September 2021 - July 2024*
BSc in Artificial Intelligence **Graduated: 110/110 Cum Laude**
Relevant Courses: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Natural Language Processing
Joint Degree between *University of Pavia, University of Milan, University of Milan-Bicocca*

PUBLICATIONS

13th International Conference on Robot Intelligence Technology and Applications
Learning to Walk with Hybrid Serial-Parallel Linkages: a Case Study on the Kangaroo Robot hal-05072198v1
Fabio Amadio, Hongbo Li, **Lorenzo Uttini**, Serena Ivaldi, Valerio Modugno, Enrico Mingo Hoffman

ArmnetBench v0.1: Parallel Real-World Evaluation of Manipulation Policies on a Low-Cost Arm Farm preprint
Praveen Selvaraj, **Lorenzo Uttini**, Ville Kuosmanen

EXTRA-CURRICULAR & SCHOLARSHIPS

LeadTheFuture: Selected as mentee (15% acceptance rate) for STEM leadership development.
San Francisco State University: Selected as Italian Country Ambassador for international meetings.
Unipv Bachelor AI Award: Awarded for ranking in the 97th percentile of my graduating cohort.
Unipv Studying Abroad Scholarship: Classified third among 300+ students to obtain a merit scholarship of 5000$ to study one semester in San Francisco awarded by University of Pavia.

SKILLS

Python, C++, Tensorflow, PyTorch, MATLAB, R, ROS2, Jax, MJX, MuJoCo, IsaacLab, Git